HALDEN TECHNOLOGIES OY

Employee Handbook

Working time, pay and benefits, leave, remote work, travel and expenses, information security, health and safety, conduct, performance and leaving the company.

Version 4.2, effective 1 January 2026

Fictional company. All people, rules, amounts and addresses are invented test data.

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1 About this handbook

1.1 Purpose and scope

This handbook explains how employment at Halden Technologies Oy works: working time, pay and benefits, leave, remote work, travel and expenses, information security, health and safety, conduct, performance and leaving the company. It applies to all employees in Finland and Estonia, whether permanent, fixed-term, part-time or on a trainee contract.

Halden Technologies has about 420 employees and offices in Helsinki, Tampere and Tallinn. Where a rule differs by country or office, the text says so. Where nothing is said, the rule applies everywhere.

1.2 Status of this document

The handbook describes company policy. It does not replace your employment contract, a collective agreement or the law. If this handbook and your employment contract disagree, the contract prevails. If a statutory rule gives you more than the handbook, the statutory rule applies.

The People team owns the handbook and reviews it once a year, normally in November. Changes take effect on 1 January unless the notice says otherwise. The revision history is in Appendix F.

1.3 Who to ask

Start with your manager. For questions about pay, leave or contracts, contact the People team. For questions about devices, accounts or security, contact the IT service desk. Contact details are in section 12.

The companion Workplace and Onboarding Guide covers the offices, starting at Halden, the tools and IT help, and the 2026 calendar with paydays and public holidays. The handbook sets the rules; the guide explains how to follow them day to day.

2 Working at Halden

2.1 Types of employment

Halden offers permanent, fixed-term, part-time and trainee employment. A fixed-term contract states the reason for the fixed term and its end date. Part-time employees receive pay, leave and benefits in proportion to their working time, except where a benefit is stated as a fixed amount (for example the wellbeing allowance in section 3.5).

2.2 Probation period

Every new employee has a probation period of 6 months. For a fixed-term contract shorter than 12 months, the probation period is half of the contract length, and at most 6 months. During probation either side can end the employment with 14 days' notice. The employer must give a reason that is not discrimination or otherwise unlawful.

Probation is extended by the length of any absence of more than 30 days, for example long sick leave. The employee is told in writing when probation is extended.

2.3 Working hours

The regular working time is 37.5 hours a week, which is 7.5 hours a day from Monday to Friday. Halden uses flexible hours: you can start between 07:00 and 10:00 and finish accordingly. Core hours, when you should be available, are 10:00 to 15:00. Lunch of 30 minutes is not counted as working time.

Teams agree their own meeting hours inside the core hours. No meeting should be scheduled before 09:00 or after 16:00 without the consent of everyone invited, and not at all on the employee's agreed day off.

2.4 Overtime and on-call duty

Overtime must be approved by the manager before it is worked. The first two hours of overtime in a day are paid at the normal hourly rate plus 50 percent; further hours that day are paid at the normal hourly rate plus 100 percent. Instead of pay, you can agree with your manager to take the time off at the same ratio. Overtime must be paid or compensated within the following two months.

On-call duty is voluntary unless it is part of your role description. An on-call day pays an allowance of €40. Hours actually worked during on-call are paid as overtime if they exceed your regular daily hours, and otherwise at the normal rate. After a night call-out that ends after 01:00, you may start work at 12:00 the next day with full pay.

3 Pay and benefits

3.1 Salary and payday

Salary is paid monthly on the 15th. If the 15th is not a working day, it is paid on the last working day before it. A pay slip is available in the payroll portal on the day of payment. Report errors to the People team within 30 days; mistaken underpayments are corrected in the next payment.

Holiday pay follows the statutory rules. A holiday bonus of 50 percent of the holiday pay is paid together with the June salary for leave taken in the leave year, as described in section 4.1.

3.2 Salary review and bonus

Salaries are reviewed once a year in March, after the annual performance review (section 10.2). Changes take effect on 1 April. The result of the performance review does not guarantee a raise, but a rating of 1 (needs improvement) excludes a performance-based increase.

All employees who have worked at least three full months in the year take part in the company bonus scheme. If the company reaches its yearly targets, the bonus is up to 8 percent of annual salary, paid in March of the following year. Employees who leave before the payment date do not receive the bonus, unless the employment ended through redundancy.

3.3 Pension and insurance

Employees in Finland are covered by the statutory employment pension (TyEL). Halden also offers a voluntary supplementary pension: after two years of service, the company pays 3 percent of salary if the employee pays at least 2 percent. Employees in Estonia are covered by the statutory funded pension and receive the same company contribution to a pension plan of their choice.

Every employee has accident insurance at work and on the way to and from work, and travel insurance on business trips. Life insurance of three times annual salary is included for permanent employees.

3.4 Occupational health care

Occupational health care is provided by Medifit. It covers general practitioner and nurse visits, health checks and referrals to specialists at no cost to the employee. One dental check-up a year is covered; other dental care is not. Appointments are booked in the Medifit app or by phone (section 12). Occupational health care also covers employees on fixed-term contracts of more than six months.

3.5 Lunch, wellbeing and bike benefits

The lunch benefit is €9.00 per working day in Finland and €7.00 per working day in Estonia. It is paid as a taxable benefit on the lunch card and is not given for days of leave or sick leave.

The wellbeing allowance is €300 per calendar year for sports, culture or other wellbeing activities. It is a fixed amount, also for part-time employees, and is reimbursed against receipts. Unused amounts do not carry over.

The bike benefit lets permanent employees lease a bicycle through the company. The retail price can be at most €2,500, the leasing period is 36 months, and the employee pays the monthly cost from gross salary. If employment ends during the leasing period, the employee can take over the lease or return the bike.

4 Leave and absence

4.1 Annual leave

The leave year runs from 1 April to 31 March. Employees earn annual leave for each full month worked in the leave year: 2 working days a month if the employment had lasted less than one year on 31 March, and 2.5 working days a month if it had lasted a year or more. A full leave year therefore gives 30 working days.

Halden adds extra leave for long service: 1 extra working day after 5 years of service and 2 extra working days after 10 years. Appendix A shows the entitlement by service.

The summer leave of at least 4 consecutive weeks is taken between 2 May and 30 September. The remainder, the winter leave, is taken at a time agreed with the manager before the leave year ends.

Request leave in the HR system at least 2 weeks ahead for up to 5 days, and at least 6 weeks ahead for 10 or more consecutive days. The manager answers within 5 working days. During busy periods a team may be asked to avoid overlapping leave, but approved leave is not withdrawn except in an emergency.

Up to 5 days of unused leave can be carried to the next leave year with the manager's written approval. Other unused leave is paid out at the end of the leave year only when the employment ends.

4.2 Sick leave

Tell your manager by 09:00 on the first day of absence. Sickness of up to 3 calendar days can be certified by the employee, at most three times in any rolling 12 months. From the fourth day, or when the limit is exceeded, a medical certificate from Medifit or another doctor is needed.

During sick leave the company pays full salary for the first 30 calendar days of each period of sickness. After that, the sickness allowance from Kela (Finland) or the Health Insurance Fund (Estonia) is paid to the employee, and the company's payment ends. Two sickness absences separated by less than 30 days count as one period.

4.3 Family leave

Parental leave follows the statutory rules. In addition, the company pays full salary during the first 60 working days of leave for the parent who takes the longer leave, and during the first 20 working days for the other parent. In practice the company pays the difference between the statutory parental allowance and the employee's normal salary for those days.

Temporary childcare leave is available when a child under 10 falls ill suddenly: up to 4 days for each illness. The company pays full salary for the first 2 such days in a calendar year; further days are unpaid or taken as annual leave.

4.4 Other paid leave

Reason	Paid days	Conditions
Study leave	5 a year	Approved studies or exams that support the role. Apply 4 weeks ahead.
Bereavement, close family	3	Spouse, child, parent or sibling.
Bereavement, other relatives	1	Grandparent, grandchild, parent-in-law or similar.
Own wedding	1	Within 30 days of the wedding.
Moving house	1 a year	On the day of the move, with proof of the new address.
Volunteering day	1 a year	Registered non-profit work arranged with the manager.

Paid days for study leave are in addition to the training budget described in section 10.4. Other leave not listed here can be agreed as unpaid leave of up to 12 months, subject to the manager's and the People team's approval.

5 Remote and hybrid work

5.1 Hybrid model

Most roles at Halden are hybrid. Employees may work remotely for up to 3 days a week. Teams agree on at least one common office day each week; by default Tuesdays and Thursdays are team days at the office. Roles that need physical presence, such as the office service team, are exceptions and are not eligible for remote days.

Remote work is voluntary for the employee and is agreed with the manager. It can be limited temporarily, for example during onboarding or when a performance plan is in place. Working hours and availability follow section 2.3 wherever you work.

5.2 Home office support

Employees who work remotely at least 8 days in a month receive a home office allowance of €25 for that month. After probation, an employee can claim a one-time equipment allowance of €400 for a desk, chair or similar. The equipment allowance can be claimed again after 4 years. Screens, keyboards and headsets can be borrowed from IT for free.

5.3 Working from another country

You can work remotely from another EU or EEA country or the United Kingdom for up to 20 working days in a calendar year. The request must be sent to your manager and the People team at least 4 weeks ahead, because working abroad can affect tax, social security and insurance.

Working from other countries is not allowed, except on an approved business trip. Time spent travelling counts as working abroad if work is done during it.

6 Travel and expenses

6.1 Approval and booking

All business travel must be approved by the manager before booking. Trips with a total estimated cost of more than €2,000 also need the approval of the department director. Flights, trains and hotels are booked through the TravelDesk platform, which applies the rules below automatically.

6.2 Transport rules

- Flights shorter than 6 hours are booked in economy class. Flights of 6 hours or longer may be booked in premium economy.
- Business class is not allowed unless the CFO has approved it in writing before booking.
- Trains are booked in second class. Taxis are allowed when public transport is not practical or after 22:00.
- Rental cars need the manager's approval. Using your own car is paid €0.55 per kilometre, plus €0.03 per kilometre for each passenger.

6.3 Hotels

Hotel prices have a nightly limit that includes breakfast and taxes. The limits for the main cities are in Appendix B. For cities not listed, the limit is €150 within the EU and €200 elsewhere. A hotel above the limit needs the manager's approval before booking.

6.4 Daily allowance

A daily allowance is paid for trips of more than 6 hours. In Finland the partial allowance (more than 6 hours) is €24 and the full allowance (more than 10 hours) is €54. Rates for other countries are in Appendix C.

If meals are provided free of charge, the allowance is reduced: by 25 percent for a free breakfast and by 50 percent for each free lunch or dinner. If all three meals are provided, no allowance is paid.

6.5 Claiming expenses

Submit the expense claim in the expense system within 30 days of the end of the trip. Attach a receipt for every expense; receipts are not needed for daily allowances and mileage. Approved claims are paid within 10 working days.

The following are not reimbursed: alcohol, fines and parking penalties, minibar and personal entertainment, travel costs of family members, and costs that exceed the rules without prior approval.

> **Note.** A claim submitted after 30 days is paid only if the manager and the Finance team agree to the delay in writing.

7 IT and information security

7.1 Devices and accounts

Halden provides a laptop and a phone where the role needs them. Devices are encrypted and managed by IT; the screen locks after 5 minutes of inactivity. Do not install software outside the Software Center, and do not connect personal USB drives. Encrypted company drives can be requested from IT.

Personal phones can be used for email and calendar only through the managed work app. Confidential data must not be stored on personal devices.

7.2 Passwords and multi-factor authentication

Passwords must have at least 14 characters. Halden Vault, the company password manager, is mandatory for work passwords. Multi-factor authentication is required for all systems that support it, and always for remote access.

7.3 Data classification

All company information belongs to one of four classes, described in Appendix D: Public, Internal, Confidential and Restricted. The class decides how the information may be stored, shared and printed. If you are unsure, treat the information as Confidential until you have asked.

7.4 Using AI tools

Only AI tools on the approved list on the intranet page may be used with company information. Confidential and Restricted information must never be entered into AI tools that are not on the list. A person must review AI-generated content before it is sent to a customer, published or used in a decision about a person.

Employees are responsible for the content they produce with AI tools, including mistakes. Do not enter personal data about customers or colleagues into an AI tool unless the tool is approved for personal data.

7.5 Reporting incidents

Report a lost or stolen device, a suspected phishing email that you opened, or any suspected leak of data to the security team immediately and at most within 1 hour of noticing it. Do not wait to see whether the problem goes away. The Data Protection Officer decides whether the supervisory authority must be notified; the legal deadline for that notification is 72 hours.

8 Health, safety and wellbeing

8.1 Safe workplace

Every floor has trained first aiders and marked assembly points. Evacuation instructions are posted near the stairs. Report every accident, near miss and unsafe condition to your manager and to the facilities team within 24 hours, using the safety form on the intranet.

8.2 Ergonomics

You can request an ergonomic assessment of your workstation at the office or at home. The assessment is arranged within 10 working days of the request, and the company pays for adjustments that the assessor recommends.

8.3 Mental health support

The employee assistance service MindWell is free and confidential. Each employee gets up to 6 counselling sessions for each issue, and can book them without telling the manager. If more sessions are needed, occupational health care can refer the employee to treatment.

9 Code of conduct

9.1 Respect and equal treatment

Everyone is treated with respect. Discrimination, harassment, bullying and offensive behaviour are not accepted, in the office, online or at company events. If you experience or see such behaviour, tell your manager, the People team or the SpeakUp channel. Reports are handled confidentially, and retaliation against a person who reports in good faith is a disciplinary matter.

9.2 Gifts and hospitality

You may accept a gift from a customer or supplier if its value is at most €50, and it is not cash or a cash equivalent. Gifts worth more than €50 must be declined or reported to your manager and the compliance officer, who decide what happens to them. Reasonable business meals are allowed. Never offer or accept anything to influence a business decision.

9.3 Conflicts of interest and outside work

Declare any personal interest that could affect your work, such as owning part of a supplier, to your manager. Outside employment or a business of your own needs the written approval of your manager if it could compete with Halden, use company time or resources, or affect your ability to do your job.

9.4 Speaking up

The SpeakUp channel is run by an external provider and is open 24 hours a day. You can report a concern anonymously. The report is acknowledged within 7 days, and the reporter receives feedback on the action taken within 3 months.

9.5 Social media

You may share public company news. Do not publish Internal, Confidential or Restricted information. When you write about Halden in a private account, make clear that the views are your own.

10 Performance and development

10.1 Yearly cycle

Goals are agreed with the manager by 31 January. A mid-year check-in takes place in August and is not rated. The annual review is held in February and March.

10.2 Rating scale

Rating	Meaning
1	Needs improvement: results are below the expectations of the role.
2	Partly meets expectations.
3	Meets expectations: reliable, good results in the role.
4	Exceeds expectations in important areas.
5	Outstanding: results and impact well beyond the role.

Ratings are discussed in a calibration meeting of managers so that they are consistent across teams. Employees can ask the People team to review a rating they disagree with within 14 days of the review discussion.

10.3 Promotions and internal moves

Promotions are decided twice a year, in April and October. After 12 months in a role, an employee may apply for an internal vacancy without the current manager's approval; the manager is informed before an offer is made.

10.4 Training budget

Each employee has a training budget of €1,500 per calendar year for courses, books and conferences that support the role. The budget does not carry over. Training that takes more than 3 working days needs the manager's approval even when it is within the budget. Mentoring is available through the People team and is free of charge.

11 Leaving Halden

11.1 Notice periods

After the probation period the employee's notice period is 1 month if the employment has lasted up to 5 years, and 2 months if it has lasted more than 5 years. The employer's notice period follows the law and the employment contract; it is never shorter than the employee's. Notice must be given in writing.

11.2 The last weeks

- Return all equipment, including the laptop, phone, badge and bike lease items if applicable, by the last working day.
- Unused annual leave is paid out with the final salary.
- An exit interview with the People team is offered. It is voluntary.
- Access to systems ends at the end of the last working day.
- A reference letter is issued within 5 working days of a request.

11.3 Records after employment

Payroll records are kept for 10 years after the employment ends. Other personnel records are deleted after 2 years unless the law requires a longer period.

12 Contacts and support

12.1 Who to contact

Topic	Contact	Details
Contracts, pay, leave	People team	people@halden.example, +358 20 555 0101
Devices, accounts	IT service desk	servicedesk@halden.example, +358 20 555 0102, weekdays 08:00 to 17:00
Security incidents	Security team	security@halden.example, +358 20 555 0103, answered at all times
Expenses and travel	Finance team	expenses@halden.example
Occupational health	Medifit	Medifit app or +358 20 555 0104
Counselling	MindWell	mindwell.halden.example, free and confidential
Reporting a concern	SpeakUp	speakup.halden.example, open 24 hours, anonymous reports allowed
Data protection	Data Protection Officer	dpo@halden.example

Appendix A: Annual leave by service

Leave is earned per full month worked in the leave year (1 April to 31 March). The table shows the entitlement for a full leave year.

Situation	Earned per month	Days per full year	Extra long-service days	Total per year
Employed less than 1 year on 31 March	2.0	24	0	24
1 to under 5 years of service	2.5	30	0	30
5 to under 10 years of service	2.5	30	1	31
10 years of service or more	2.5	30	2	32

Example: an employee who started on 1 June 2023 has more than a year of service on 31 March 2025 and earns 2.5 days a month. In the leave year 2025 to 2026 they earn 30 days. They reach 5 years of service on 1 June 2028; from the leave year in which this happens they receive one extra day.

Appendix B: Hotel limits per night

Limits include breakfast and taxes.

City	Limit per night
Helsinki	€170
Tampere	€150
Tallinn	€130
Stockholm	€190
Berlin	€160
London	€240
New York	€330
Other EU cities	€150
Other cities outside the EU	€200

Appendix C: Daily allowances

Allowances are per day for trips of more than 6 hours (partial) or more than 10 hours (full). Trips abroad are paid at the full rate when they last more than 10 hours.

Country	Partial day (over 6 hours)	Full day (over 10 hours)
Finland	€24	€54
Estonia	€24	€48
Sweden	€40	€79
Germany	€36	€71
United Kingdom	€42	€84
United States	€44	€88

Appendix D: Data classification

Class	Examples	Rules
Public	Published news, marketing material, job advertisements	May be shared freely.
Internal	Internal announcements, meeting notes, this handbook	Share only inside Halden and with partners under contract.
Confidential	Customer contracts, pricing, source code, employee records	Store only in approved systems. Share on a need-to-know basis. Encrypt when sent outside Halden.
Restricted	Authentication secrets, health data, unpublished financial results	Strict access list. Never copy to personal devices or unapproved tools. Print only with the owner's permission.

Appendix E: Glossary

Term	Meaning
Core hours	10:00 to 15:00, when employees should be available (section 2.3).
Leave year	The period from 1 April to 31 March in which annual leave is earned and taken.
Probation	The first 6 months of employment, with a 14-day notice period (section 2.2).
Kela	The Social Insurance Institution of Finland, which pays sickness allowance.
TyEL	The Finnish statutory employment pension.
TravelDesk	The platform for booking business travel.
Halden Vault	The company password manager.
SpeakUp	The external reporting channel for concerns.
Calibration	A meeting of managers to make performance ratings consistent.
Per diem	A daily allowance paid for business trips of more than 6 hours.

Appendix F: Revision history

Version	Date	Main changes
4.2	1 January 2026	AI tools rules added (section 7.4). Hotel limits raised in Appendix B. Equipment allowance raised from €300 to €400.
4.1	1 January 2025	Working from another country limited to 20 days (section 5.3). Bike benefit added.
4.0	1 January 2024	Handbook rewritten. Hybrid work model introduced. Probation set to 6 months.
3.3	1 January 2023	Wellbeing allowance introduced. Lunch benefit raised.

Appendix G: Quick reference

The key figures of this handbook in one place. If a figure differs from the section it comes from, the section is correct.

Topic	Rule	Section
Weekly hours	37.5 hours; core hours 10:00 to 15:00	2.3
Probation	6 months; 14 days' notice	2.2
Payday	15th of the month	3.1
Company bonus	Up to 8 percent of annual salary	3.2
Lunch benefit	€9.00 Finland, €7.00 Estonia, per working day	3.5
Wellbeing allowance	€300 per calendar year	3.5
Annual leave	30 working days; 24 in the first year; extra days from 5 and 10 years	4.1, Appendix A
Sick leave	Self-certify up to 3 days; full pay for 30 days	4.2
Remote work	Up to 3 days a week; 20 days a year abroad	5.1, 5.3
Expense claims	Within 30 days; paid within 10 working days	6.5
Gift limit	€50	9.2
Security incident report	Within 1 hour	7.5
Training budget	€1,500 per calendar year	10.4
Notice period	1 month up to 5 years of service, 2 months after	11.1